

Radiant Hall Studios

Executive Summary

Community Partner

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Student Consulting Team

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Background

Radiant Hall is a Pittsburgh-based nonprofit arts organization that provides affordable studio space, shared resources, and community for local artists across four neighborhood locations: Homewood, Lawrenceville, McKees Rocks, and a Downtown site in development. Operating approximately 50,000 square feet of studio space and hosting nearly 400 artists since 2012, Radiant Hall serves as a key infrastructure anchor in the greater Pittsburgh arts ecosystem. The organization is staffed by an executive director, a managing director, and several part-time roles, including studio directors, a facilities manager, and program staff. With a constrained operating budget, Radiant Hall prioritizes low- or no-cost technology solutions. Core digital tools include Google Workspace, Discord, Squarespace, QuickBooks, and Zapier, managed manually and largely in isolation, creating significant administrative overhead for a lean team.

Project Description

Project Opportunity

Two operational bottlenecks were identified as most critical to Radiant Hall's mission. First, a broken automation between the Squarespace inquiry form and Google Sheets forced the Managing Director to manually copy-paste 100+ annual applicant records, resulting in a disorganized waitlist where artist status histories were inconsistently tracked. Second, the absence of a self-service reservation system for shared resources, for example, kilns, classrooms, and event spaces, meant artists had to email or text directors for every booking, creating a communication bottleneck and frequent double-bookings. A prior attempt using a dedicated "Tactic" booking software failed due to adoption barriers.

Project Vision

Our vision was to transform Radiant Hall's administrative operations from a collection of manual workarounds into a streamlined digital ecosystem built entirely on tools the organization already uses and trusts. By streamlining the pipeline between a well-organized Google Sheets and Google Forms and establishing a centralized, self-service booking system, the project aimed to eliminate double-handling of data, empower artists with resource autonomy, and free leadership to focus on high-impact strategic priorities such as the planned Downtown expansion.

Project Outcomes

For the waitlist management system, the Google Apps Script pipeline connects Google Forms directly to a structured Working Waitlist spreadsheet, auto-generating readable Google Docs for each submission, performing duplicate detection, and auto-sorting rows by priority and status. The clients now have a clear and structured workflow for navigating the waitlist data instead of having to work with hundreds of unstructured rows. For the booking system, we created a clear, familiar path for artists to reserve shared spaces without contacting staff. A YouCanBook.me booking system was configured and linked to Discord and Squarespace, enabling self-service scheduling for shared resources, while also distinguishing open-access resources from restricted ones.

Project Deliverables

For the waitlist management system, our project deliverables include two Google Forms (New Enquiries and Relocation Enquiries), a restructured Google Sheets Working Waitlist, plus auto-generated Google Doc response summaries linked in the sheet. For the booking system, our deliverables include a configured YouCanBook.me environment integrated with Discord and Squarespace, supporting multiple booking durations, resource-specific pages, and approval workflows for restricted resources such as kilns. Additionally, we also include a comprehensive waitlist documentation guide covering sheet structure, workflow phases, form management, script modification, and troubleshooting, and a scheduling system documentation guide covering setup, ownership transfer, and feature configuration; and video walkthroughs for common staff tasks.

Recommendations

To ensure long-term system health and high adoption, for the booking system, we recommend promoting the YouCanBook.me booking interface actively through Discord and the website, with the guides visible on both platforms. Providing a faster response through the system will also incentivize adoptions. For the waitlist management system, we recommend retaining the original Google Sheets as a read-only backup for at least six months, and before making any script changes, always export a full code backup via the Apps Script editor. For staff continuity, studio directors should also be walked through their personalized filter views at the earliest opportunity.

Student Consulting Team

Opally Taebunyanuphap worked mainly on the Waitlist Management Solution and served as the person who set up the meeting agendas and notes. She is a third-year student majoring in Information Systems with a concentration in Data Analytics. She is looking toward a career in data science and data analysis, especially in the field of education and criminal justice.

Jordan Fon Sing worked mainly on the Waitlist Management Solution and served as the contact person for the community partners. He is a senior student majoring in Information Systems with an additional major in Business Administration. He is looking forward to a career in project financing in New York after graduation.

Cheyu Tu worked mainly on the Scheduling System Solution and served as the person who organized the sprint reports and project deliverables. She is a senior student majoring in Information Systems with minors in Human-Computer Interaction and Animation & Special Effects. She is starting her career as a full-stack software developer after graduation.